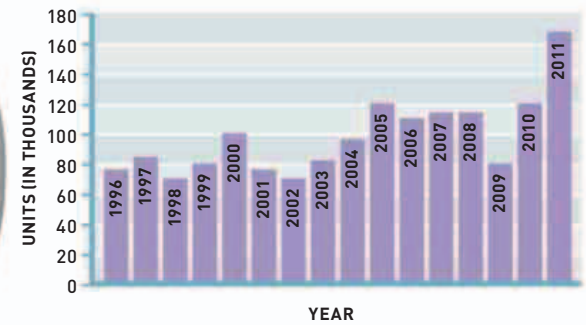


hands mimic human hands, with four fingers and a thumb

face plate conceals stereo cameras for object recognition and distance calculation

on-board computers allow ASIMO to recognize and interpret movement and gestures



Annual supply of robots

There has been a steady increase in the annual supply of robots worldwide. Experts predict this will rise exponentially in the future.

Honda ASIMO

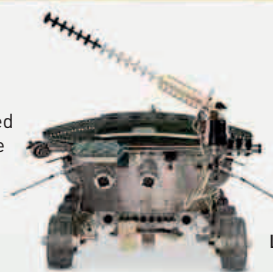
Launched in 2000, this 4 ft- (130 cm-) tall humanoid robot is capable of performing a variety of complex tasks, such as walking over uneven surfaces and recognizing and picking up objects.

1966
Artificially intelligent
Designed at Stanford Research Institute, California, "Shakey" is the first robot to use artificial intelligence to make independent decisions.



Shakey

1970
Moon rover
USSR's remote-controlled Lunokhod 1 becomes the first robot to operate on the surface of the Moon, paving the way for later Mars rovers.



Lunokhod I

2000
Humanoid robot
Japanese engineering company Honda unveils ASIMO, the world's most advanced humanoid robot to date.

Aibo



1999
Robot dog
Aibo, a doglike toy robot developed by the Sony Corporation, is capable of responding to a range of stimuli, displaying artificial intelligence and developing a "personality."

2000
Telepresence
The da Vinci robot surgeon is a telepresence device that uses robotic technology (with a skilled human controller) to operate on a finer level than can be achieved by human hands.



Da Vinci robot surgeon

2010
Robonaut II
This humanoid robot, carried aboard the International Space Station, tests the potential for the use of telepresence on future space missions.